

Tibet. You can learn firsthand that Mexicans seldom cook spicy food, that the French like to be rude, that Japanese businessmen get drunk in public, and that restrooms in Lima don't have towels to dry your hands. You can also learn new ways to cook, dance, dress, and even think.

Closer to home, a retired dad can buy season tickets to the Dodgers, Raiders, and Lakers—or whoever the local teams may be—and actually take the kids to the games. You can get into keeping the stats. Learn how many times Willie McCovey stole second off the pitcher, how many spitters Don Drysdale threw per nine innings, and how many products Pete Rose endorsed in his career.

The mind at age 40 absorbs knowledge quickly. Dedicate yourself and you can become one of the world's experts on Martin Luther, Isaac Newton, Ty Cobb, acid rain, tribal customs, ocean currents, or naval warfare. You and your kids can collect or build model soldiers, guns, planes, or trains. You can give talks comparing Kierkegaard to Nietzsche, Sartre to Malraux. You can become a roving private ambassador or a specialist in young African nations or maritime law.

Use your imagination. Suppose your boss walks in tomorrow and gives you a three-year sabbatical. Let's say the company has a special program to enable key workers to recharge their batteries. You're to spend the three years enjoying yourself, doing anything you want. What would you do? Bosses who grant three-year sabbaticals are about as common as big-hearted loan sharks who forgive and forget loans. But think about what you'd do for three years. And remember you can do it on your own, without the sabbatical, if you follow the rules in this book.

When you retire you have time to pursue any or all of your interests. You can even go to the club and talk about business if you want to. When you're living on \$50 a day, going to lunch with someone on an expense account is a splurge. Those banquets, cocktail parties, and Christmas bashes that used to be a chore are fun when you don't do them every